Cincinnati Bengals / opponent rulebook

Snapshot October 22, 2026. Games through week 6, last game October 19. Public-data demonstration for weekly preparation.

Situation / outcome	All matching	Discovery	Check
Third-and-long five-plus rush Five-plus actual rushers	7/30 5 games	7/25	0/5
Third-down blitzers At least one charted blitzer	11/51 5 games	10/42	1/9
Early-down five-plus rush Five-plus actual rushers	20/138 5 games	16/115	4/23
Five-plus rush against motion Five-plus actual rushers	18/98 5 games	16/88	2/10
Five-plus rush against shotgun Five-plus actual rushers	24/158 5 games	21/131	3/27
First-down loaded box Seven-plus box	47/135 5 games	35/108	12/27
Five-plus rush in the red zone Five-plus actual rushers	6/28 5 games	3/23	3/5

Original held-out check: lower Brier is better

Five-plus actual rushers: 33 plays, 1 games. Model 0.1361; base rate 0.1287. GREY: no demonstrated improvement over base rate.
At least one charted blitzer: 33 plays, 1 games. Model 0.1361; base rate 0.1287. GREY: no demonstrated improvement over base rate.
Seven-plus box: 63 plays, 1 games. Model 0.2475; base rate 0.2382. GREY: no demonstrated improvement over base rate.

Interpretation and limits

Discovery uses weeks 1-4; check uses complete games in weeks 5-6. The policy was fixed before that original check. The next-game estimator now uses all snapshot rows. This is development evidence, with no fresh validation. Rule frequencies do not have independent rule-level predictive validation. Current coverage, safety shell, named rushers, personnel effects, split-formation effects, and concept success are unavailable. Five-plus actual rush is not a quarterback-pressure event. Rehearsal ideas are coaching hypotheses, with no measured concept advantage.

FTN Data via nflverse, with nflfastR/nflverse play-by-play. Adaptations: filtered rows, joins, flags, and summaries. This rulebook and the demo adaptation are CC BY-SA 4.0. Retain attribution and reuse rights. PBP is CC BY 4.0. No BDB or proprietary feed is included.
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